

Lecture 10

Unit 1 An Overview of Argumentative Writing

Review--Differences among Narrative, Expository and Argumentative

[Reference](#)

Narrative	Expository	Argumentative
For recording some events or entertaining the readers	For explaining the items or educating the readers	For convincing or persuading the readers to support their points regarding of some topic
With personal experiences and emotions	Without personal emotions or perspectives	With intensively personal emotions and perspectives

What is Argumentation

An Aspect of Human Cognition

- Constantly happened in our daily lives.
- Present a sound **thesis or claim**.
- **Support** it with carefully selected **evidence**.
- Point out the flaws in the **opposing view**.
- Come to a well-phrased, powerful **conclusion**.

An Aspect of Human Communication

The Process of Critical Thinking

Critical Thinking is the **objective analysis** and **evaluation of an issue** in order to **form a judgment**.

Basic Concepts Underlying Argumentation

Argument

A set of assumptions information from which conclusion can be drawn. The assumptions are called the **support(premises)** and the **conclusion** is called the **claim** of the argument. The claim is **questionable or open to doubt**.

Rebutting Argument

An argument containing a claim that is the **negation** of the claim of **another argument**. (**complete negation**)

Undercutting Argument

An argument containing a claim that **contradicts some of assumptions** of another argument. (**partial negation**)

Counterargument

Either is a rebutting argument or an undercutting argument.

Proponent and Audience

Assume each argument has a **proponent**, the person putting forward the argument, and has a **audience**, the person intended as the recipients of the argument.

Underlying Assumptions of Argumentation

- With an audience in mind.
- Under conditions of uncertainty.
- Providing support for claims.
- Cooperative enterprise despite its adversarial nature.
- entails risks.